

Apple HomeKit

Not one to be left in the dust, Apple came up with its HomeKit framework for home automation. Smart device manufacturers can implement it into their products which can in turn be controlled by a few apple devices. The HomeKit not only lets you communicate with these smart devices, but also lets them communicate with each other making it easier to automate things. Also, every HomeKit compatible device will work with Siri.

There's still a long way to go

We started off this chapter by asking why we need smart hubs when we already have so many smart devices. And the answer is: to make our lives simpler by providing us with a central command centre to control all of them. But how much simpler have these devices made life? And can smart houses become even more simpler?

Controlling all the smart devices in your house from a single application on your phone is a very cool thing. But when you must look for your phone every time you forget to switch off the kitchen lights, you'll realise that the coolness of the tech wears off. The future of smart homes lies in voice controlled AI assistants, like Alexa and Siri, interacting with you in real time and doing what you are asking it do. You can still have a setup like this by connecting your Amazon Echo or Google Home speakers to your smart hub which in turn is connected to all your smart device. A step further is for these assistants to anticipate needs and not just comply with human inputs.

Home automation is supposed to make our lives simpler and not complicate it. It is a relatively new field of technology which is constantly evolving. All we can do right now is wait and hope that 10 years down the line, we all will have our own smart homes powered by Just Another Rather Very Intelligent System. 